

Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA) Contracts Management Office (CMO)
Request for Information (RFI) – End to End Automation & Evaluation Tools
(DARPA-SN-25-60)

Responses Accepted: Until **4:00 PM Eastern Time (ET) on Wednesday, March 26, 2025**

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INTRODUCTION:

For more than 65 years, DARPA has held to a singular and enduring mission: to make pivotal investments in **breakthrough technologies for national security**. The DARPA Contracts Management Office, in collaboration with the six (6) Technical Offices, is also pursuing innovation from an acquisition and business process perspective with end goals to leverage commercial capabilities to maximize intra-agency collaboration and to streamline and automate internal business and federal contracting processes to increase acquisition velocity in support of DARPA's vital mission.

BACKGROUND and SCOPE:

DARPA CMO is requesting capability statements in **3 Focus Areas** described below from commercial sources with expertise in Artificial Intelligence (AI), Large Language Models (LLMs), and end to end automation, to enhance DARPA's existing rapid transition from each step of the acquisition process (requirements and solicitation generation through abstract and proposal evaluations to eventual award and execution). Capabilities may include existing tools and/or potential development of new tools. DARPA is currently operating in an integrated MS 365 environment; therefore, any contemplated tools/solutions must be compatible to this environment.

*****Companies can submit capability information to one or more Focus Areas.*****

1. Focus Area 1 (Requirements and Solicitation Development):

DARPA is the premier Research and Development (R&D) organization with the Department of Defense (DoD). DARPA has 6 buying divisions within the CMO – while DARPA's focus is primarily on R&D efforts, our "Services" buying division is essential to agency operations. DARPA is seeking a provider to assist in the "requirements and solicitation development" process, leveraging any "best in class" AI, LLM, and automation solutions to meet our mission. To that end, below are some examples of areas of interest; however, **these examples are not all inclusive**.

- A. Automated Solicitation Generation: Interest in potential AI/LLM-powered tools that can automatically generate draft solicitations based on predefined templates and user inputs. Interest in solutions for generating merit-based solicitations for R&D objectives.
- B. Market Research Integration: Interest in integrating market research tools that can analyze industry trends, competitor capabilities, and pricing data to inform solicitation development.
- C. Interest in tools/solutions that would review solicitation announcements for requirements defining language that reads like a Statement of Work (SOW) or Statement of Objectives (SOO) to ensure merit-based solicitations such as Broad Agency Announcements (BAAs) do not contain overly restrictive verbiage, such as an overuse of the words "shall" or "must."
- D. Tools/solutions capable of collecting, consolidating, and routing for review Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) to identify similar questions and answers from previous DARPA solicitations are of significant interest.
- E. Interest in tools/solutions that could incorporate a calendar planning model for upcoming

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BAAs, Program Solicitations, and office-wide awards (with estimates for number and types of awards).

- F. Interest in custom Generative Pre-training Transformers (GPTs) for Procurement Packages – This would be especially helpful for development of procurement packages for task orders placed against internal Indefinite Delivery Indefinite Quantity (IDIQ) vehicles. It is envisioned that a custom GPT could contain a series of prompts for the customer to answer with the result being the generation of a SOW/Performance Work Statement (PWS) and an Independent Government Cost Estimate (IGCE).
- G. Interest is in automating document routing and workflow approvals.
- H. Interest in a tool that will gather and generate key industry trends and historical data that will assist a business financial manager in developing budget material for new program concepts.
- I. Interest in a tool that will capture the New Program Start process, from inception of technical idea(s) through publishing the solicitation.

2. Focus Area 2 (Abstract and/or Proposal Evaluation Tools):

DARPA is seeking a provider to deliver and implement a robust source selection software solution that accepts abstract and proposal submissions and aids decision makers with abstract and/or proposal evaluations. The software must enable evaluations that are compliant with Subpart 15.3 (Source Selection) of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) and Subpart 215.3 (Source Selection) of the Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement (DFARS) and referenced documents in both regulations. It is also desired that the software is fully customizable to meet other non-FAR requirements and agency needs.

Technical Description: Responses should include information about available training and coaching plans and a description of the tool's capabilities and features across the following list:

- A. Number of evaluators who can participate in a single source selection activity using the tool.
- B. Number of concurrent source selection activities the tool can support.
- C. Accessibility to software for evaluators in multiple physical locations.
- D. Number of proposals that can be included in a source selection activity within the tool.
- E. Ability to create tailored and weighted scoring criteria.
- F. Ability to automate compliance verification for abstracts/white papers/proposals within the tool.
- G. Ability to conduct analysis of evaluation data and produce summary reports.
- H. Ability to export data, such as, names, emails, descriptions, and evaluator comments from the tool.
- I. Ability to provide tailored responses to proposers, consolidating evaluator comments into actionable technical feedback.
- J. Features available to guide users during their evaluation role. Interested in ability to identify deficiencies and/or lack of clarity in written evaluations.
- K. Ability to operate with classified documents.
- L. Auto generate notifications to unsuccessful offerors. Notification of winning offeror(s).
- M. For capabilities that include existing software tools, what challenges/limitations have been experienced with the software tool? Have customers made any requests of the S/W that have not been successfully addressed? Is the next generation of the S/W tool in process? If yes, what

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is the anticipated release date?

- N. Has your organization had any experience with using the MS PowerSuite or similar technology to Perform a Source Selection Evaluation? If yes, can you identify any strengths or weaknesses? Did you face any challenges?
- O. Ability for the tool/solution to facilitate real-time collaboration and communication among evaluators, including features like shared annotations, discussion forums, and instant messaging that could enhance transparency and efficiency in the evaluation process.

3. **Focus Area 3 (Pre-Award, Award, and Post-Award Stages):**

DARPA is seeking a provider to deliver tools and solutions that assist with federal acquisition activities in the pre-award, award, and post-award stages. Below are some examples of areas of interest; however, **these examples are not all inclusive**.

- A. Automated Contract Performance Monitoring: Interest in potential for AI/LLM-powered tools that can monitor contract performance in real-time by analyzing data from various sources (e.g., deliverables, invoices, performance reports).
- B. Predictive Analytics for Contract Management: Interest in tools that can leverage predictive analytics to identify potential risks and opportunities throughout the contract lifecycle.
- C. Interest in tools/solutions for a workable contract file system that could fully integrate with all other system inputs (Contract Writing System, Financial System, and any procurement package development system, reviews, etc.).
- D. Interest in tools/solutions that will aid Contracting, Grants, and Agreements Officers in determining the fairness of proposed prices through price, cost, and value analysis.
- E. Interest in ability for automated System for Award Management (SAM) registration verification and other inputs toward making a responsibility determination, after receipt of proposals and before award.
- F. Interest in tools/solutions that will automatically pull the Supplier Performance Risk System (SPRS) assessment.
- G. Interest in a bot for population of most data elements required in a Price Negotiation Memorandum (PNM)/Agreements Analysis (AA) document that support a Contracting, Grants, and Agreements Officer's determinations.
- H. Interest in data analytics and reporting tools that can provide actionable insights from contracting data. This could include visualizations and automated reports that track key performance indicators (KPIs), identify trends, and support data-driven decision-making across all stages of the acquisition process.

ELIGIBILITY:

DARPA invites participation from all providers who can be cleared to participate in Department of Defense source selection activities.

CONTACT INFORMATION:

All responses to this RFI and all technical and administrative correspondence and questions regarding the RFI must be emailed to DARPA-SN-25-60@darpa.mil. Emails sent directly

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to DARPA personnel may result in delayed/no response. Responses will be accepted any time from the publication of this RFI until **4:00 PM Eastern Time (ET) on Wednesday, March 26, 2025**. Early responses are encouraged.

REQUESTED INFORMATION and SUBMISSION FORMAT:

Responses should be in Microsoft 365 or Adobe compatible formats with 12-point font for main text section.

Responses should have the following **3** sections:

1. **Cover Sheet**: Provide the following information.
 - A. Response title.
 - B. Identification of proposed Focus Area(s) interest.
 - C. Technical point of contact name, organization, telephone number, and email address.
 - D. Business size and classification (e.g. large, small, small disadvantaged, SBA Certified 8(a), HUBZone, service- disabled veteran-owned, etc.)
 - E. Existing Government contract vehicles that could be used for this effort, if any.
 - F. Evidence of successful performance within the past three (3) years of similar or related work assisting source selection processes for Department of Defense organizations.
2. **Visual References**: Optional but highly encouraged.
 - A. Screenshots and other visuals that demonstrate the look and feel of the tool while highlighting capability.
 - B. Links to video demonstrations of the tool and its capabilities – do NOT submit video files as part of your response to this RFI.
3. **Focus Area(s) Detailed Response (no more than 10 pages per Focus Area submission)**:
 - A. For each Focus Area, provide detailed information on the proposed tool(s) and/or solutions, addressing the examples and questions.
 - B. Describe your business model and cost regarding purchase and sustainment.
 - C. Provide schedule/timeline for implementation for each proposed tool and/or solution.
 - D. Provide detailed information on your organization's current cybersecurity posture, including any relevant certifications, compliance with industry standards (e.g., NIST, CIS), and implementation of federal security frameworks. Include specifics on your data protection measures and encryption protocols to protect source selection sensitive and proprietary information.

SUBMISSION NOTES:

1. Responses containing proprietary information must be clearly marked on each page containing such information with a label such as **“Proprietary”** or **“Company Proprietary.”**

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2. **DO NOT INCLUDE ANY CLASSIFIED INFORMATION IN THE RFI RESPONSE.**

3. DARPA may coordinate further with respondents as necessary to gain a full understanding of the information submitted. DARPA may contact respondents individually via e-mail/phone.

DISCLAIMERS AND IMPORTANT NOTES:

1. This is a RFI issued solely for information and planning purposes; it does not constitute a formal solicitation for proposals. In accordance with FAR 15.201(e), responses to this RFI are not offers and cannot be accepted by the Government as such.
2. This RFI **is not intended** to address active DARPA solicitations such as Broad Agency Announcements, Program Solicitations, and/or Research Announcements. Questions regarding active solicitations are not relevant to this RFI and will not be addressed.
3. Responses do not bind DARPA to any further actions related to this topic including requesting follow-on proposals from respondents to this RFI.
4. Submission is voluntary and DARPA will not provide reimbursement for costs incurred in responding to this RFI.
5. Respondents are advised that DARPA is under no obligation to acknowledge receipt of the information received or provide feedback to respondents with respect to any information submitted under this RFI.
6. DARPA will disclose submission content only for the purpose of review. Submissions may be reviewed by the Government (DARPA and other Government partners); Federally Funded Research and Development Centers (FFRDCs); and Scientific, Engineering and Technical Assistance (SETA) support contractors.